

THE CHANGING LANDSCAPE OF PHOTOGRAPHY

Technology is leapfrogging photography into new realms. And that's not a complaint

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From the days of yore when cameras were mostly used to take pictures of dead people, to today, where we click pictures of everything under the sun, photography has changed a lot. But no more so than in the past decade, fueled by tech innovation. Thanks to technology and science, several specialised fields of photography have emerged – astro-, underwater-, aerial-, etc.

Cameras, however, aren't just limited to documenting scenes anymore, but in fact are helping us drive, park, take off in drones, really take off in space exploration, and also for things like security and various sensors. Cameras and photography are headed for new frontiers, and whilst we cannot predict what will happen to photography in the next decade, we do have an inkling about the immediate future...

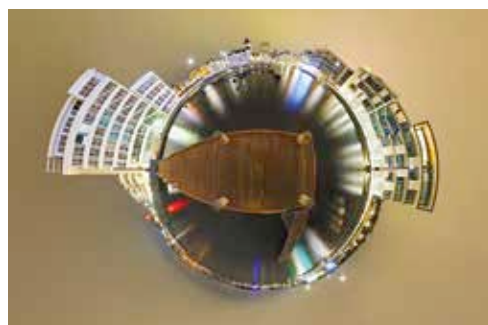
FULL CIRCLE

Ever since Google Cardboard became a thing, and Facebook also jumped on the 360-degree bandwagon, we're pretty sure that every single one of you has already seen a 360 degree video or picture. You're going to see a lot more of them. When the first precursor of the 360 photo, Photosphere, launched in late 2012, with the Nexus 4 (It was built into Android 4.2, but was

first available on the Nexus 4), it had only a lukewarm reaction. Sharing it via Google Photos wasn't ideal and the photos took a long while to process and stitch, so people just didn't bother with it back then. As hosting and sharing became easier with Facebook spearheading it, it received a huge burst in popularity and it's poised to go even further. The Samsung Galaxy S8 and S8+, which came out recently, allow you to stream your life in this fashion by pairing your phone with a Gear 360. Andy Rubin's Essentials PH 1 which is going launch soon, takes this one step further – as an attachment that clips on to the phone to make the process even simpler.

SHOOTING FROM DRONES

We mean the harmless kind. Aerial views are nice. It's why so many of us want window seats on airplanes. Drones give you that without the cramped legroom and bad food, and with better imagery and control. You've no doubt seen some stunning aerial shots of landscapes, cities, beaches, etc, which used to only be possible by renting ridiculously expensive helicopter rides. Manufacturers like DJI have packed quality hardware into their offerings, allowing even beginners to get quality footage – and the price of entry is going down constantly too! While those sub \$100 drones won't shoot any jawdropping footage, they do pretty well for most use cases. People are now using drones to map and survey real estate properties (Not to mention shooting some sick shots for the ad promos), shoot footage of guests at weddings and other events, scout out paths and clearings for treks and strolls outside, monitor animals like whales and much more. This is definitely one of the most rapidly burgeoning frontiers of modern photography and we can't wait to see where it reaches next.



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